

Why it invents citations

WHY IT INVENTS A PAPER

ask: "cite a study on AI in Indian agriculture"

Sharma, R. & Patel, K. (2021).

"Machine Learning for Crop Yield Prediction in Punjab."

Indian Journal of Agricultural Science, 58(3), 214-229.

Author names: plausible ✓

Journal: real ✓

Format: perfect ✓

The paper does not exist.

Nothing looked it up. There is no
lookup step in the model at all.

A convincing fake scores exactly as well as a real one while predicting text

Never accept a citation you have not opened

Plausible shape, no lookup step

A made-up reference is not a lie. It is the model doing **exactly what it was built to do**.

- 1 It predicts text that *looks* like a citation — author, year, journal.
- 2 A plausible-looking fake scores as well as a real one during prediction.
- 3 It has no lookup step, so nothing checks whether the paper exists.

REMEMBER

Never accept a citation you have not opened. This failure is structural.

